JJ KOCH | AWARD WINNING SEARCH MARKETER

I TURN SEARCH INTO A GROWTH ENGINE.

I run SEO, paid search and AI search as one growth program, measured in pipeline and revenue rather than rankings. Software engineer by training, search marketer by track record: a 20-person agency practice and its P&L, a 13-region enterprise program, and a growth-stage SaaS search engine that became the company's largest measured pipeline source. Two US Search Awards Silvers in 2026.

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DIRECTOR OF SEO & AI SEARCH — DEPOSCO

SEARCH PIPELINE

+75%

Search-sourced pipeline, year over year, across all three channels; closed-won ACV up 36%. The company's largest measured pipeline source.

PAID PIPELINE

+169%

pipeline on a 15% spend increase; ROAS up 134%

Silver · USSA 2026

AI PIPELINE

10 opps · 2 won

from an AI search channel built from zero; 67% demo-to-opp; 46.8% visibility vs a 20% goal

Silver · USSA 2026

AGENCY SEO REVENUE

+233%

leading a 20-person team and its P&L through an M&A (Acadia)

WHAT THE JUDGES SAID

"A highly impressive, data-driven approach to AI search optimisation, grounded in genuine buyer language rather than assumptions. The connected attribution, analytics and tracking framework was particularly strong, creating a credible way to measure AI search impact through the pipeline and commercial journey."

Judges, 2026 US Search Awards · Best AI Search Optimization Campaign, Silver

GROWTH-STAGE B2B SAAS · JUN 2025 – PRESENT — ALPHARETTA, GA

Director of SEO & AI Search · Deposco

Three channels, one program: search pipeline up 75% year over year.

BUDGET SEVEN FIGURES REPORTS TO CMO MARKET WMS & SUPPLY CHAIN SAAS FOR 3PLS, RETAILERS, BRANDS
PARTNERS DIRECTED 5: PAID SEARCH, REDDIT, ANALYTICS & CRO AGENCIES, SEARCH CREATIVE

SEO

Top-3 rankings up 107%

Visibility 11.8% → 22.1%; the only domain in its competitive set to grow its footprint (+61%)

PAID SEARCH

+169% pipeline, +15% spend

ROAS up 134%; CFO-approved budget increase; Microsoft and ChatGPT Ads launched

AI SEARCH

From zero to closed-won

10 opportunities, 2 closed-won, 67% demo-to-opp; 46.8% visibility vs a 20% goal; #1 on the priority topic

- Run search as a revenue engine with RevOps and sales: every search-sourced opportunity tracked from **first conversion to closed-won in HubSpot**, on attribution finance has approved
- Set the executive agenda on search: standing briefings to the **C-suite and finance**, a 199-person all-hands on AI search, and board slides for the CMO
- Built the **digital demand engine models for the US and UK annual operating plans**, both adopted by the CMO; co-lead marketing's AI enablement initiative, building Claude Code agents with Semrush and HubSpot connectors

GLOBAL ENTERPRISE · NOV 2022 – MAY 2025 ATLANTA, GA

Global SEO Manager · Manhattan Associates

Held organic traffic up 15% across 13 regions while AI Overviews cut top-result clicks by a third.

REGIONS 13 LANGUAGE SITES 14 CHANNELS SEO + PAID SEARCH PRODUCT OWNER GA4

- Grew organic traffic **21%** and organic-sourced sales-accepted-opportunity (SAO) ARR **17%** in 2024; held traffic up 15% in 1H 2025 as AI Overviews cut position-one click-through 34.5% on affected queries (Ahrefs, Apr 2025)
- Increased ranking queries 62% and **page-1 rankings plus SERP features 255%**, including AI Overview placements for primary product terms
- Guided a **Drupal-to-Optimizely replatform** across 14 language sites with rankings preserved; exceeded paid search SAO ARR targets by **52%** at a consistent 10x ROAS
- Built Data Studio dashboards for global teams, presented in executive QBRs, and trained regional teams; **2025 US Search Awards finalist**, Best Use of Search – B2B (SEO); Manhattan Associates **Spirit Award**, Rockstar Rookie category

AGENCY · DEC 2016 – OCT 2022 ATLANTA, GA

Director of SEO · Acadia

Built the SEO practice to 20 people and grew its revenue 233%.

TEAM 20 (13 IN-HOUSE, OFFSHORE, FREELANCE) MANAGERS 4 P&L OWNED REPORTED TO COO
PATH ANALYST 2016 → MANAGER 2018 → DIRECTOR 2019

- Accountable to the C-suite for the practice's results and profitability; grew SEO revenue **233%**, the top-performing team company-wide
- Managed **four managers** and their teams across 13 in-house SEOs, offshore staff, freelance writers, and link-building partners; owned hiring and built the training program that scaled the unit
- **Co-pitched new business** with sales; clients grew keywords, traffic, and leads 27% a year on average, near 100% where SEO recommendations were prioritized
- Clients included Georgia-Pacific, Hexagon AB, WellSky, Bark, Ideal Image, Greenlight, Red Roof Inn, and ClearChoice; led the team through a **merger and acquisition** with client delivery intact

2015 – 2016 **Jr. Software Developer**, University of North Georgia · PHP, JavaScript, SQL, and C# development

2014 – 2016 **Online Marketing Analyst**, Premade Paleo · Ran a Shopify store's SEO, content, and email marketing

AWARDS

2026	**Best AI Search Optimization Campaign** US Search Awards · Deposco	SILVER
2026	**Best Use of Search, B2B PPC** US Search Awards · Deposco	SILVER
2026	**Best Use of Search, B2B SEO** US Search Awards · Deposco	FINALIST
2026	**Search Marketer of the Year** Search Engine Land Awards · Deposco	FINALIST
2026	**Best B2B Search Marketing Initiative, SEO** Search Engine Land Awards · Deposco	FINALIST
2025	**Best Use of Search, B2B SEO** US Search Awards · Manhattan Associates	FINALIST
2022	**Small Agency of the Year** Ad Age · Acadia, while running its top revenue-growth practice	SILVER

EDUCATION

University of North Georgia · Bachelor's, Computer Science, 2016 · Dean's List

SKILLS & TOOLS

What I work with

SKILLS

AI search optimization (GEO/AEO) · Pipeline attribution · Google, Microsoft & ChatGPT Ads · Technical SEO · Content & international SEO · Executive reporting · Budget forecasting · Agency & partner management · Replatforms & migrations

PLATFORMS

Claude Code agents + MCP · HubSpot · Salesforce · Semrush · Profound · GA4 · Looker Studio · Demandbase · Screaming Frog · Ahrefs · Optimizely · Notion